

Communication Expense Policy

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Document status: Detailed fictional enterprise reference policy for RAG development and testing.

Important: This document is a reference policy, not an actual policy issued by a specific company. Replace rates, approval authorities, tax treatment and local requirements with your organization's approved rules before production use.

Purpose

Defines reimbursement rules for mobile, roaming, data, internet and communication costs.

1. Scope and Definitions

Applies to employees, contractors and other workers who incur authorized business travel expenses.

1.1 Business Travel

Business travel means travel away from an employee's normal work location for an approved business purpose.

1.2 Policy Principles

- Expenses must have a legitimate business purpose.
- Employees must use reasonable and economical options.
- Expenses must be submitted accurately and on time.
- Duplicate reimbursement is prohibited.
- Falsified or altered receipts may result in disciplinary action.

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Employee

- Obtain required approval.
- Use approved suppliers where available.
- Retain receipts and supporting evidence.
- Submit complete and accurate claims.
- Repay unused advances or personal amounts.

Manager

- Confirm business purpose and necessity.
- Review reasonableness and documentation.
- Approve exceptions only within delegated authority.
- Escalate suspected fraud.

Finance

- Maintain controls and audit procedures.
- Validate claims.
- Process approved reimbursement.
- Maintain records under retention requirements.

3. Eligible Communication Expenses

- International roaming for approved travel.
- Business calls.
- Business mobile data.
- Temporary business internet.
- Business-critical communication services approved by IT or Finance.

4. Illustrative Communication Limits

Expense	Reference limit	Frequency	Documentation
Mobile reimbursement	INR 2,000	Monthly	Telecom bill
International roaming	Actual reasonable cost	Per trip	Invoice + travel dates
Temporary internet	Actual reasonable cost	Per trip	Receipt/invoice

5. Corporate Mobile Users

Where the company provides a corporate mobile plan, employees should not claim the same subscription or usage cost through a personal expense claim.

6. International Roaming

Roaming is reimbursable for approved international business travel when needed for business. Use company-negotiated plans where available. Large or unusual charges require justification.

7. Internet and Wi-Fi

Hotel or venue internet may be reimbursed when required for business and not already included. Personal streaming, entertainment subscriptions and non-business services are excluded.

8. Personal Phone Usage

Where a BYOD program permits business use of a personal device, reimbursement should follow the approved allowance or documented incremental business cost.

9. Documentation

Claims should include provider, billing period, amount, currency and relevant travel information. Finance may request itemized bills for unusual charges.

10. Security and Privacy

- Use approved VPN/security controls where required.
- Follow company security guidance on public Wi-Fi.
- Do not expose confidential information through unsecured communication.
- Report lost or stolen company devices under the security incident process.

11. Non-Reimbursable Communication

- Personal streaming services.
- Gaming or entertainment subscriptions.
- Personal international calls.
- Unauthorized device purchases.
- Late-payment fees caused by employee action.
- Duplicate reimbursement under corporate and personal plans.

12. Approval and Exceptions

Costs above the normal allowance require business justification and approval according to the applicable exception matrix.

13. FAQs

Can I claim international roaming?

Yes, when the trip is approved and roaming is needed for business, subject to applicable limits.

Can I claim my entire mobile bill?

Only the eligible business amount or approved allowance should be claimed.

My roaming bill exceeds the allowance. What should I do?

Submit the itemized bill and explain the business circumstances. Additional reimbursement depends on the approved exception process.